

Something blinked in the well.

I clutched its edge harder and stood up on my tiptoes to look closer, squinting. Trying to see what it is. Parents talked in the background, something about our new house and the door that apparently got stuck and couldn't be opened. It was boring. Their conversations had always bored me; it was just how adults were.

As I leaned closer, I almost immediately felt someone pulling me back by the shirt and, looking up, I saw the stern face of my mother.

'You are going to fall in there,' she said, with a disapproving curl on her lips, 'better go play in the garden.'

And so I did. But I also did come back to the well. I wanted to prove to myself that it wasn't just the play of light that I saw, but something else, something... tangible.

I was watching inside it again, this time under the inky black sky, when the sparkle appeared. So, my child's mind eliminated the sunbeam. Was it fish then, I thought?

How long had it been there? Had it been swimming completely alone, with no friends?

I stretched my arm as far as I could to reach it, but, of course, it didn't happen. I screamed in the fear of falling and woke up my mother, who immediately dragged me back into the house.

Next time I had to wait until my parents sat in front of the TV. And while they were watching their boring news, I sneaked outside to look at the fish again. It was so far away, floating at the bottom of the well, but it sparkled brightly under the midday sun, and it looked like gold. I was so happy to have a golden fish.

I had been feeding it bread crumbs and candies all June, but the fish refused to eat. It only floated in the murky water, so distant and so beautiful with its golden scale.

Even as a child I could comprehend something was wrong, but couldn't pinpoint what it was. Eventually, I made a decision to abandon the idea completely, and that's when I had the strangest dream.

In my dream I was in the room that my parents couldn't open, and it was filled with water, but most importantly I wasn't alone there. The golden fish, that I'd been taken care of, swam around, sparkly and happy to be outside.

I woke up with a start and that's when I knew what I had to do.

I was trying to fetch that golden thing from the well, when I heard mother's screams to get back from it, but I didn't stop. And fortunately, I had succeeded before she pulled me from the well. Her angry face turned confused as she was looking at me.

I stood before her with a rope tied to magnet and a wet golden key that I had been confusing for a fish all this time.

My mother led me to the closed door and let me open it.

Inside was an old nursery, and I had already got bored with this solved mystery, when suddenly something caught my attention.

A small empty fish tank, ready for its new occupant.